names of recruits in India who he believed were staunch supporters of the network. Jindal said there was one final hurdle that he had asked Sethi to resolve: what was the network's next move? Sethi promised to deliver the information. Bhardwaj handed him a miniature tape recorder and told him curtly that the proof needed to be solid. In the meantime, he forwarded the names of the Indian module to the R&AW headquarters. This subsequently landed on the desk of P.V. Narasimha Rao, who temporarily served as home minister from March to May 1986 before Buta Singh was handed the responsibility of internal security.

Jindal was informed sometime in April that eighteen people on the list had been neutralised in a covert operation and they had launched a manhunt for nine others. As promised, Sethi delivered a tape sometime in July 1986. The conversation among the network involving Khan, Sandhu and the ISI officers revealed a plan to expand the operation and the Pakistani intelligence officers assured substantial sums of money for the attacks. Bhardwaj decided that the R&AW should go head to head with the network. Through his contacts in MI5, he managed to convince the British about the covert activities of the ISI officers. As for Sandhu and Khan, Bhardwaj decided to escalate the matter to the top brass, seeking a go-ahead for further missions. In July and August, Bhardwaj was informed by his contacts in British counterintelligence agencies that the Pakistanis had been told to shut shop. He was, however, cautioned that the ISI might just shift the base of antiIndia operations back to Islamabad. At that point, the MEA issued a statement for public consumption that Pakistan was unwilling to mend its ways and continued to support terror activities in India and was also making attempts to internationalise the Kashmir issue.